buying a second house close to the store, one that was at 1618 Tenth Avenue, for $9,500.

It was their deliberate intention to extend their real-estate holdings bit by bit until their rental receipts covered mortgage, maintenance, and taxes, with enough left over to make it possible for them to retire from the candy-store business.

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I received a personal letter from Orson Welles on March 3, 1947, and I was delighted and impressed. He said he'd be in New York City soon and would like to meet me.

Alas, he never came; or if he came, he certainly never got in touch with me. That letter, added to the $250, was all I ever got for trifling away the electronic rights to "Evidence" forever.

I made a closer contact with another celebrity. Arnold Toynbee's A Study of History, which Sprague had admired so and to which he had introduced me, had roused the interest of Time, and Toynbee had become a world celebrity.

On March 10, 1947, Toynbee was lecturing at Bryn Mawr, near Philadelphia, and Sprague was enormously excited. He suggested I come to Philadelphia to hear Toynbee, and although my own infatuation with Toynbee had passed, I have always found it difficult to resist Sprague, whom I have always admired just this side of idolatry both as a person and as a writer.

I went to Philadelphia, therefore, and, in Sprague's company, listened to an hour lecture by Toynbee on contacts between civilizations. I found it fascinating, and afterward, when Sprague managed to make his way to Toynbee and to introduce me, I was delighted at the opportunity of shaking hands with the man.

Afterward, Sprague and a few others started a "Toynbeean Society" and I was made "temporary secretary." Nothing very much happened to the Society after that (that I knew of, at least), so I suppose it didn't get far.

Meanwhile, I was working steadily and successfully at my research, which consisted of making many, many "chronometric" measurements.

It worked thus: A certain quantity of enzyme was mixed with and allowed to work on a compound called catechol. While it was working, drops of the